

Consolidation Discovery: Research Plan

Judges, CAs, Other Chambers

Consolidation - July 12, 2022

This research will take place during [sprint number] July 11, 2022 - July, 29, 2022	
Related Story	Other Notes
Story 9445 Story: 3820 Story: 5483 Story: 342 Story: 2379 Story: 3571	Notes for completed interviews to be documented in Google Forms Consolidation Mural Notes

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Overview & Purpose

Background information on why this research is needed

The purpose of this research is to engage with USTC Judges, CAs, and Other Chambers Staff to better understand their experiences with consolidation and to identify opportunities for improvement. USTC stakeholders have prioritized 1 Epic with 4 stories at this time which outline the following objectives:

[EPIC] 3820: “Consolidation” of two or more cases

- Understand user workflows and usability concerns related to consolidation of cases

Story 5483: Consolidated Cases: Display on Dashboard

- Inform the workflow, design, and usability of the consolidation dashboard display

Story 342: Consolidation of cases - System automatically suggests

- Determine whether or not automation would improve the user experience and if so, inform the design and usability of the automation

Story 3571: Court User - QC Edits for Consolidated Cases

- [UX likely not needed] Create consistency by applying edits from one QC across all consolidated cases

Story 9445: UX Design/Research

- Identify pain points for consolidation across all associated users and flows in DAWSON.

Research Goals

Overall aim or vision to outline the purpose of our work

- 1. Understand and document the unique perspectives, needs and experiences of Judges, CAs, and Other Chambers Staff as related to consolidation**
- 2. Define key moments in the user’s experiences to identify opportunities to improve the consolidation process**
- 3. Create an enhanced user experience across DAWSON’S consolidation process**

Guiding Questions

Overarching “big picture” questions we want to answer through this research

* These questions will not be asked directly to users. Interview guide is outlined below.

- What are users expectations when consolidating cases?
 - What do users need and value?
 - How can we make it easier for users to complete their tasks?
- How does consolidation integrate into a larger workflow?
- How have users done this in the past?
- What challenges and opportunities are there with this process?
 - What areas of the UI impact their experience most?
 - How should we prioritize our improvements?

Research Methods

How we will approach our research to gather the information we need

- 1:1 non-standardized interviews
 - Duration of 45-60 minutes
 - Scheduled remotely via zoom

Engagement Groups

A list of people we will speak with to learn more about their experiences

In order to gather diverse perspectives from people that utilize DAWSON, we will meet with 9-15 users with representation from the following category:

Interviewee Participants	
User Type	Approx. # of participants
Judges	1-3
CAs	6-8
Other Chambers Staff	2-4

Recruitment Email

Email template for scheduling interviews with participants

Subject: DAWSON Consolidation Interview

Good Morning _____,

Thank you for completing the recent survey about consolidated cases in Dawson. You had indicated that you'd be interested in providing more feedback. If you are still interested, we would like to schedule a 45-minute discussion with you via Zoom. Please provide us with three days and times for the week of July 18, within the 11am-4pm EST timeframe, that works for you.

We'll do our best to accommodate your schedule. Thank you, we greatly value your feedback and time.

Regards,

Lia and Sui

Interview Guide

Questions we will reference to guide our conversations with users

Slack reminder for team

Post this message in slack 30-60 minutes before an interview.

Hi team! We're about to start another user interview at [ADD TIME] If you'd like to join, please reply in a thread to this post. The first team member to respond gets to join.

A few things to remember:

- You can access the zoom link here: [ADD LINK]
- Only 1 extra team member per interview. We don't want to overwhelm the participant.
- Join on time and stay the whole time. If you can't make the entire interview, we kindly ask you to skip.
- Save questions for the end. Please jot down any questions that come up for you via your personal notes. We will open up the last 5-10 minutes for questions or clarifications.

Intro Script

Hello! My name is _____. I am a User Experience Researcher / Designer working with the U.S. Tax Court and I want to thank you for agreeing to spend time with me today. I have a member / two members of my team in the meeting _____, who is a UX Researcher / Designer and will be taking notes, & _____ who is a _____ and will be observing.

As we mentioned in the email, we want to gather more feedback about consolidation in Dawson to help inform our designs. We will be asking you a series of questions and at the end, you will get a chance to bring up topics we didn't that are related to consolidation.

Participation in this interview is completely voluntary and optional. You can terminate the session at any time for any reason. Your responses are confidential and when the findings are reported, they will be aggregated and anonymized so that nothing that is said can be tied directly to you.

Please note that we are performing this research to validate ideas and find pain points in Dawson, and we are not testing you as a participant. Feel free to be as open and candid as you would like and don't hold back your opinions. You will not hurt anyone's feelings.

Would it be okay if we record this meeting for note-taking purposes? Your feedback will be kept entirely anonymous and will only be used internally for reporting.

Does that sound good? Any questions before we get started? [Do not record if screen-sharing PII]

Introduction [approx 20-30 min]

Notes submitted in [Google Forms](#) for each interview.

- To start, can you tell us a what is your current role with the Tax Court?
 - What are your responsibilities?

Consolidating Cases

- How often do you encounter consolidated cases? For instance daily, weekly, estimated frequency?
- What tasks do you perform in relation to consolidated cases? What challenges, if any, occur when performing these tasks? (if they don't mention messaging, go to the next question)

Case Message

- How do you use the case message feature within a case? What challenges do you face when using this feature?

Collaboration with Judges/CAs

- How do you collaborate with the CA/Judge on consolidated cases? (if interviewing a CA, use 'judge'. If interviewing a judge, use 'CA').

Scheduling

- Does consolidation impact trial session scheduling? If so, how?

Session Copy

[Screenshare Session Copy page.](#)

- What are your thoughts on the Session Copy page? How do you know what's consolidated?
 - Probe further depending on their answers.

Conclusion

- We've heard there's a need to be able to add and serve documents to all/multiple cases in a group simultaneously. What else, if anything, would make consolidation easier for you in Dawson?
- Any final thoughts or comments?

Outro Script

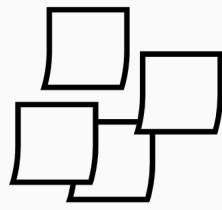
Thanks again for your time and feedback. We truly appreciate it. Know that you are helping to improve Dawson by participating in these sessions. If you think of anything else, please feel free to email us. Have a wonderful day.

Synthesis Process

[Overview of how we will synthesize interview data](#)

Our team will utilize affinity mapping to synthesize our interview data and research.

- Data and first-hand accounts from interviews will be transformed into stickies in Mural
- All interview data will be anonymized by a unique participant ID
- Similar stickies will be grouped by theme to uncover insights about the user experience
- Human-centered insights will serve as the foundation for opportunities to improve DAWSON



Review and analyze
interview data



Identify patterns and
discover themes



Articulate insights that
point to opportunities

Outcomes

[What will come out of this research](#)

The research gathered from the users will uncover human-centered insights that will serve as the foundation to inform the future design and functionality of DAWSON's consolidation process for online cases.